

FAMILY TOGETHERNESS WEEK OF PRAYER
SEPTEMBER 7-13, 2025

GOD'S *great* GIFTS

I WILL GO WITH MY FAMILY:

CELEBRATE CREATION:
MARRIAGE, FAMILY, AND THE SABBATH

GOD'S
great
GIFTS

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Willie and Elaine Oliver: Editors
Karen Holford: Principal Contributor
Dawn Venn: Senior Editorial Assistant
Daniel Taipe: Design

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Adventist®
Family Ministries

GENERAL CONFERENCE OF SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTISTS

12501 Old Columbia Pike, Silver Spring, Maryland 20904, USA

301.680.6175 office

family@gc.adventist.org

family.adventist.org



@Adventist.Family



/AdventistFamilyMinistries



TABLE OF CONTENTS

4	INTRODUCTION WITH LOVE, GOD!
13	SUNDAY GOD'S GREAT GIFT OF LOVE
18	MONDAY GOD STARTS TO MAKE OUR WORLD
23	TUESDAY GOD CONTINUES TO CREATE OUR WORLD
28	WEDNESDAY GOD'S GREAT GIFT OF MARRIAGE
33	THURSDAY THE GREAT GIFT OF LOVING FAMILIES
38	FRIDAY GOD'S GREAT GIFT OF SABBATH
43	SABBATH THE DELIGHTFUL GIFT OF SABBATH



INTRODUCTION

In the beginning, God's heart overflowed with love, and that love found its ultimate expression in three magnificent gifts that would crown His work of creation: marriage, family, and the Sabbath. While the first six days of creation week reveal God's power and artistry in forming the physical world, it is these three divine institutions that reveal the very heart of His character and His deepest desires for humanity.

"For God so loved the world that He gave His only begotten Son, that whoever believes in Him should not perish but have everlasting life" (John 3:16). This verse captures the essence of

God's giving nature—a nature that was evident from the very beginning when He established these sacred gifts as the foundation for human flourishing.

Throughout creation week, we witness an intentional progression. Light conquered darkness, waters were separated to create sky and sea, dry land emerged with abundant vegetation, celestial bodies marked time and seasons, and creatures filled every corner of the earth. Each day built toward a crescendo, preparing the perfect stage for God's masterpiece: humanity created in His own image.

But God wasn't finished. After breathing into Adam the breath of life, the Creator

made a profound declaration: "It is not good that man should be alone" (Genesis 2:18). In forming Eve as Adam's perfect companion, God established marriage—the sacred union between one man and one woman that would become the cornerstone of human society. This wasn't merely about companionship; it was about reflecting God's own relational nature and creating the foundation for family life.

Marriage naturally gave birth to God's second crowning gift: family. Within the safety and love of this divine institution, children would be nurtured, faith would be transmitted, and the image of God would be passed from generation to generation. The family became God's

chosen method for filling the earth with His love and character.

Then came the ultimate crown: the Sabbath. After six days of creative work, God rested on the seventh day, blessing and sanctifying it. “The Lord has appeared of old to me, saying: ‘Yes, I have loved you with an everlasting love; therefore with lovingkindness I have drawn you’” (Jeremiah 31:3). The Sabbath represents this everlasting love made tangible—a weekly invitation for families to rest in God’s presence, to remember His goodness, and to prioritize relationship over productivity.

These three gifts—marriage, family, and Sabbath—stand as God’s

crowning acts of creation because they address humanity’s deepest needs: companionship, belonging, and communion with the Creator. Together, they form a trinity of divine institutions that continue to bless and sustain us today, reminding us that we are fearfully and wonderfully made and loved by our Creator (Psalm 139:14).



Adventist®
Family Ministries

Willie and Elaine Oliver, Directors
Seventh-day Adventist Church
World Headquarters



If you would like to expand your knowledge on families from a biblical perspective, please get our free 2025 Resource Book.

Available now in Chinese (Simplified and Traditional), English, French, Italian, Kurundi, Portuguese, Romanian, and Spanish.

Visit: family.adventist.org/2025RB

A note from the Principal Contributor

KAREN HOLFORD



This year, the focus of the week is on discovering **God's Great Gifts**.

We aim to help our family connect with God's overflowing love and recognize His gifts through creation, relationships, and Sabbath. We will explore how God's love flows from His heart to ours and then between us, learning to notice and share His love with others. Through daily worship experiences that engage all our senses—seeing His beauty, hearing birdsong, tasting fruits, and feeling His presence—we will discover that God's love surrounds us constantly, waiting to be noticed and shared.

Karen Holford is the Family, Children's and Women's Ministries Director for the Trans-European Division. She has a professional background in occupational therapy and master's degrees in psychology, Family Therapy and Christian Leadership. She is married to Pastor Bernie Holford, and they live in England. They have three adult children and three grandchildren. She loves to write, walk in English forests, and share God's love.

WHY DO FAMILY WORSHIP?

- It teaches our children and families to worship God
- Places God at the center of our homes
- Bonds our families together
- Protects our children and families
- Establishes spiritual values

UNWRAP THE BLESSINGS OF FAMILY WORSHIP

WHAT IS FAMILY WORSHIP?

WHAT FAMILY WORSHIP **IS**:

- Interactive
- Shared leadership
- Brief and engaging

WHAT FAMILY WORSHIP **IS NOT**:

- A lecture, sermon, or coercive activity
- Time for discipline or punishment
- Entertainment

HOW TO DO FAMILY WORSHIP?

Worship is a time when we give adoration and praise to God. With reverence, humility, and gratitude, we make our requests to him. In the Old Testament, animals were sacrificed on the altars. **Today, we need only a sacrifice of time and self.** When we add the word family to worship, we come together to worship God as a family.

Parents especially get an **opportunity to disciple their children and teach them how to worship God.** Together, we take the time to express honor and respect to God and acknowledge Him as Lord and Savior of our lives and our home. This experience bonds us to one another and draws us closer to God.

Every family can decide how their family worship time looks and what tools they will include. It may consist of reading the bible, singing a song, and praying together as a family. But there are many ways to have family worship as many as there are families. Every family is unique, so you can custom build your family altar just for your family.

The only thing that remains the same is that we should turn our focus toward God, the Creator and Sustainer of humankind.

“

In every family there should be a fixed time for morning and evening worship. How appropriate it is for parents to gather their children about them before the fast is broken, to thank the heavenly Father for His protection during the night, and...when evening comes, to gather once more before Him and thank Him for the blessings of the day past.”

Ellen G. White,
Child Guidance, p. 520

“

There is no reason why [family worship] should not be the most interesting and enjoyable exercise of the home life, and God is dishonored when it is made dry and irksome. Let the seasons of family worship be short and spirited.”

Ellen G. White,
Child Guidance, p. 521

REMEMBER:

Your family worship may not be perfect, and that's okay. Pray to God and keep doing your best; He is with you.



**DAILY
GIFTS:**

FAMILY MOMENTS OF WORSHIP



Building a family altar is one of God's great gifts—a way to celebrate His love, creation, relationships, and Sabbath. Like Israel's loose-rock altars, yours may need rebuilding or a fresh approach when life gets busy. No shame in missing a day—just grace in returning to worship.

Let the **God's Great Gifts** devotional inspire worship through four themes: love, creation's wonder, relationships, and Sabbath rest.

Love:

Share a way you witnessed God's love.

Wonder:

Admire something in nature—perhaps a flower, a bird, or the night sky.

Relationships:

Name a time you felt God's care at home, big or small.

Rest:

Light a candle or play soft music to mark Sabbath renewal.

Customize with a song, skit, or act of simple kindness. Each moment together—no matter how brief—is a divine gift. Keep worship fresh, relevant, and age-appropriate: act out a verse, pray briefly, or sing a short song of praise. Even two minutes of intentional prayer honors God's gifts and strengthens your family altar.

HOW TO STEPS USE THIS TO DAILY RESOURCE WORSHIP

BIBLE VERSE

A Bible verse with a simple, creative activity to help you memorize it and experience it in a practical way.

FOUNDATION

INTRODUCTION

An introduction to the theme of the day and why it is good for us.

SETTING THE MOOD

DEVOTIONAL

A short devotional story designed for the whole family.

CORE MESSAGE

PRAYER

Pray together—where everyone can share their heart's desire.

COMMUNION

ACTIVITIES

Several simple activities to help you practice gratitude for God's gifts in your family life.

REINFORCING

IN A HURRY?

TRY THE **“AT A GLANCE”** SECTION AT THE END OF EVERY DAY OR AT PAGE 48